



Marking their role

Black G.A.R. veterans parade in New York City in 1912. USCT veterans and their families were determined to remind the nation of their role in the war. Although southern G.A.R. posts were segregated, some northern posts were integrated.

Reconciliation and healing

At the end of the 19th century, Northern and Southern sections of the United States entered a period of reconciliation. The Spanish-American War of 1898 was a key milestone in this process. With both sides facing a common enemy, the war brought the North and the South together, and veterans from the Union and Confederate armies began appearing in joint reunions.

The 50th anniversary of the Battle of Gettysburg in 1913 was the apex of veterans' memorialization, with more than 50,000 former soldiers attending the Great Reunion. At the "Peace Jubilee," President Woodrow Wilson declared, "We have found one another again as brothers and comrades in arms, enemies no longer, generous friends rather, our battles long past, the quarrel forgotten." (Wilson even allowed the U.D.C. to put a monument to those who took up arms against the nation at Arlington National Cemetery.)

Civil War battlefields became places of national healing. Congress established the National Military Park system at Chickamauga, Gettysburg, Shiloh, and Vicksburg. in the 1890s. It preserve the